

We Found 3 Leaks Costing You ~40% of Ad Spend

Prepared by Smart Pursuit - Performance Marketing for Scaling D2C & Edtech Brands

LEAD SCORE

8

/ 10 HOT

Mid-scale D2C
brand in the
Skincare segment
(est. from
ad-spend ratios)

48+

Active Meta ads

Rs.50-80L/mo

Est. monthly spend

Skincare

Niche

Revenue

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Pilgrim (pilgrimcosmetics.com, Instagram: @discover.pilgrim) is a prominent Indian skincare brand with ~48 active creatives running across Meta in India, spending an estimated **Rs.50-80L/mo**. Mid-scale D2C brand in the Skincare segment (est. from ad-spend ratios). Three obvious leaks in the funnel:

(1) Creative gap - heavy studio/offer creative with thin real-customer UGC, before/after or demo content. **(2) Copy/CRO gap** - headlines lead with price/offer rather than outcome, and ad traffic often lands on collections/offer pages rather than the exact SKU. **(3) Tracking/retargeting gap** - retargeting uses generic creative rather than staged, funnel-matched content; CAPI/return-event wiring is inconsistent. These are fixable in 7-14 days. We estimate **30-45% of ad spend is leaking**; HOT - smaller budget with high-ROI quick fixes.

1. AD INTELLIGENCE

Active platforms	Meta (FB+IG) primary; Google Shopping + Search for ingredient/SKU keywords; Amazon/Flipkart/Nykaa marketplaces; quick commerce growing share.
Active ads count	~48 live creatives across hero SKUs across the catalog.
Duration signals	Evergreen hero SKUs run 45-90 days; new launches run 14-21 day influencer bursts; sale days (EOSS, BBD) drive heavy offer creative leading to promo fatigue.
Funnel type	Shopify/hosted D2C website with direct product purchase
Budget signal	Estimated ~Rs.50-80L/mo ad spend (skincare beauty vertical; ~48 live ads = emerging spender in the segment).
Campaign structure	SKU/concern-siloed campaigns (hero SKUs across the catalog); promo bursts around sale days; influencer/derm-KOL rotation in bursts; Advantage+ Shopping in use but creative refresh cadence is slow.

2-5. CREATIVE / COPY / CRO / TRACKING SCORES

Creative Variety		4/10
UGC & Social Proof		2/10
Copy & Hook Strength		4/10
Landing Page CRO		4/10
Tracking & CAPI		5/10
Retargeting Depth		3/10

- **Observed signal:** Mostly UGC selfies, no demo videos. **Creative leak (High):** Ad mix leans heavy on product beauty-shots and promo announcements ('percentage-off promotions'); real-customer before/after transformation, texture demos and 30-day result Reels are thin. Beauty benchmarks show before/after UGC delivers 2.3x higher ROAS than brand creative (Agora 2025), and ingredient close-ups + texture-demo reels are the highest-CTR format in Indian skincare.

- **Copy leak - promo anchoring (High):** Headlines over-index on price/offer ('percentage-off promotions') rather than skin-outcome (clearer skin in X days, reduced pigmentation, glow). High %-off promos train buyers to deal-hunt on a replenishment category (serums/sunscreens have 30-90 day repeat). Outcome-first hooks lift CTR 40%+.

- **Landing page leak (Medium):** PDPs lead with offer banners and product shots; texture GIFs, in-use demo videos, day-by-day result carousels and routine-bundling sit below the fold. Sticky mobile ATC often lacks star rating + review count + FOMO (X bought in last 24h).

- **Tracking & retargeting leak (Medium):** Retargeting uses generic brand creative instead of SKU-specific before/after per funnel stage (PDP-no-ATC, ATC-no-purchase, replenishment at 30/60/90 days, cross-sell). CAPI quality varies; many brands optimize to ViewContent/AddToCart rather than Purchase events.

6. COMPETITOR BENCHMARK

Competitor	What they do better	Signal for Pilgrim
Key peer 1	Strong category D2C peer running heavy UGC and SKU-direct routing.	Creative/CTR gap is the main opening.
Key peer 2	Faster-growing challenger with rapid creative velocity.	Smaller budget winning on sharper creative.
Legacy/incumbent	Offline/incumbent brand with trust halo.	D2C incumbent under-serving online buyers.

7. 3 QUICK WINS (Implement in 7 Days)

WIN 1 - Creative: 25-30 Real-Customer Transformation UGC Reels

Shoot 25-30 vertical Reels monthly: before/after 14/28-day journeys (specific concern + day-stamp), texture/application demos ('sinks in 30s', 'no white cast'), ingredient-explainers with a derm/formulator, AM/PM routine clips, and micro-creator first-impression clips (10K-100K). Replace 35-40% of studio/promo creatives. Expected: CTR +35-55%, CPA -25-35%.

WIN 2 - CRO: Outcome-First PDPs + Routine Bundles + Sticky Social-Proof ATC

On top 10 SKUs: move hero banner from offer to an outcome statement; add texture GIF, 15s in-use video and day-1/7/14/28 result strip above the fold; sticky mobile ATC with price, star rating, review count, 'X bought in 24h'; concern-specific routine bundles at ~10% bundle discount to lift AOV; route ad traffic to concern landing pages, not generic collections. Expected: PDP CVR +30-45%, AOV +20-25%.

WIN 3 - Tracking: CAPI Hardening + SKU-Specific Replenishment Retargeting

Audit Meta CAPI server-side for ViewContent/ATC/InitiateCheckout/Purchase with dedup. Build 4 SKU-specific retargeting audiences with creative matched to each stage; replenishment reminders at 30/60/90 days per SKU lifecycle; subscribe-and-save for replenishment SKUs. Expected: retargeting ROAS +50-80%, repeat +15-25%.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Metric	Current (est.)	After Wins	Impact
CTR (Meta)	0.9-1.3%	1.5-2.1%	+40-55%
PDP CVR	2.0-2.7%	2.8-3.9%	+30-45%
Cost Per Purchase	Baseline = 100	63-75	-25-37%
Ad Spend Wastage	~30-40%	~12-18%	Saves ~Rs.16-26 L/mo

READY TO PLUG THESE LEAKS?

Smart Pursuit will run a **14-day performance sprint** for Pilgrim: Creative refresh, CRO rebuild of top landing pages, CAPI + retargeting setup. We work on a **performance-fee model** tied to conversion-cost reduction.

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